

# HydroPing Android App Concept

## HydroPing Android = “Your little water companion”

The Android version should not simply copy the Windows version. The core philosophy should remain the same:

HydroPing should not “notify” you. It should make you want to drink water.

On Windows, the strongest differentiator is the animated character appearing on the desktop. On Android, we can turn that into a tiny living companion that appears in different places without becoming an annoying notification app.

## 1. The main Android experience

I would build four layers.

Layer 1 — Smart notification

Don't use a generic notification.

Instead, the notification itself becomes character-driven:

Droppy

“Umm... I think we're both getting a little dry.”

Buttons:

I drank

Later

After tapping I drank, Droppy becomes happy:

“Yay! Thank you!”

Android requires notification permission on Android 13+, so onboarding should explicitly explain why HydroPing needs it.

## 2. The killer feature: HydroPing Widget

This is actually the feature I'd emphasize most on Android.

Put Droppy permanently on the home screen.

The character changes depending on the user's hydration state.

Good hydration — Droppy smiling

Getting late — Droppy waiting

Seriously overdue — Droppy looking thirsty

User drinks — Droppy celebrates

This makes the widget itself a visual reminder without being a notification.

Android's current widget system is well suited for this; Jetpack Glance provides a modern Kotlin/Compose-based way to build widgets.

## 3. Make the character feel alive

Don't have Droppy simply appear every 60 minutes.

Give Droppy a personality state machine:

HYDRATED → WAITING → A LITTLE THIRSTY → THIRSTY → VERY THIRSTY → USER DRINKS → HAPPY → HYDRATED

The character's animation changes accordingly.

At 9:00: Droppy is sleeping.

At 10:00: Droppy wakes up.

At 10:30: Droppy looks at the user.

At 11:00: Droppy becomes thirsty.

At 11:05: Notification: "Hey... water?"

User drinks.

Immediately: Droppy jumps – "Yessss! ■"

This is the soul of the application.

## 4. Don't make it interruptive

This is extremely important.

You specifically don't want:

notification → irritation → disable app.

So I'd create an Interruption Budget.

Level 0 – Silent

Widget updates only.

Level 1 – Character notification

Small notification with Droppy.

Level 2 – Persistent gentle reminder

Only if the user repeatedly ignores reminders.

Level 3 – Strong reminder

Only after a configurable amount of time.

But never spam.

And I would deliberately avoid using full-screen notifications. Android restricts full-screen intents pri

## 5. The character is the notification

The Android equivalent of the Windows desktop character should be the character-driven notification itself.

Example:

Droppy appears with a thirsty expression.

"Hey... I think it's water time ■"

Actions:

I drank

Later

The notification should feel like Droppy is communicating, not like the operating system is interrupting the user.

## 6. Floating Droppy / Companion Mode

A tiny Droppy could optionally appear over other apps if the user explicitly enables such a feature.

Settings → Companion Mode

Allow Droppy to accompany you outside HydroPing.

However, I would not make this the default because Android overlay permissions are sensitive and can make

Instead, it should be an optional advanced feature. When enabled, Droppy could occasionally appear in a s

## 7. Droppy Bubble

Android supports notification bubbles/floating UI, although the user controls whether bubbles are enabled.

HydroPing could optionally offer a persistent little companion:

■ Droppy

Tap:

You are 450 ml behind your goal.

[ Drink ] [ Later ]

Again, optional, not forced.

## 8. Make drinking itself satisfying

Don't just record:

250 ml added.

Make it an interaction.

User taps:

I drank

Droppy does a short drinking animation and celebrates:

“Nice! That's one more!”

This gives users a tiny dopamine loop:

Reminder → Drink → Interaction → Reward

## 9. Don't make users constantly enter millilitres

Give quick choices:

How much did you drink?

150 ml

250 ml

350 ml

500 ml

Custom

And remember the user's usual choice.

If they almost always drink 250 ml, the primary action becomes:

I drank 250 ml

One tap.

## 10. “I'm drinking now” mode

When the reminder arrives:

Droppy says it's water time!

User taps:

I'm drinking

Droppy changes to a drinking/waiting state:

“I'll wait...”

After a short period:

“Done?”

User taps:

Yep!

Droppy celebrates.

This creates a small interaction rather than a boring notification.

## 11. Smart reminder engine

Don't simply do:

every 60 minutes

Instead:

Reminder interval

+

Recent drinking

+

User activity

+

Sleep schedule

+

Work schedule

+

Ignored reminders

↓

Next reminder

For example, if the user drinks at 9:05, don't automatically remind at 10:05. The next reminder can adapt

If the user repeatedly ignores reminders, HydroPing should progressively back off rather than spam.

## 12. “Droppy knows when you're busy”

This is particularly important for the non-irritating philosophy.

If someone is watching YouTube for two hours, don't make HydroPing repeatedly shout:

DRINK WATER!

Instead, Droppy can appear quietly.

If the user dismisses it:

“Okay... I'll wait ■”

Then back off.

This creates non-irritating persistence.

## 13. Home-screen progress

Avoid a boring percentage circle.

Instead, let Droppy visually represent progress.

For example:

Droppy

5 / 8

“Doing great!”

As the day progresses, Droppy visually changes.

Morning: sleepy

Afternoon: happy

If behind: thirsty

Goal achieved: celebration

## 14. Daily “relationship” with Droppy

Not just:

Today's hydration: 1.8 L

Instead:

Droppy's day

Good morning!

You and Droppy started the day at 8:12 AM.

7 drinks

1.75 L

82% of goal

Droppy says:

“You're doing great today!”

## 15. Characters become a major feature

Your Windows version already has:

Droppy

Whiskers

custom characters

I'd carry that architecture into Android.

But improve it with personality.

Droppy — energetic, cute, encouraging

Whiskers — slightly sarcastic

“Water. Now. Please.”

Future characters can have their own styles and dialogue.

## 16. Character customization

Let users choose:

Character

- Droppy
- Whiskers
- Future characters
- Custom

Personality

- Cute
- Funny
- Calm
- Motivational
- Silent

Reminder style

- Gentle
- Playful
- Persistent
- Minimal

This is important because cute for one person can be annoying for another.

## 17. Android Quick Drink

Put a HydroPing action in Android Quick Settings if appropriate.

Example:

Wi-Fi Bluetooth

HydroPing

+250 ml

Tap it:

+250 ml

Done.

The user doesn't even need to open the application.

## 18. Lock-screen interaction

The reminder could be designed to be useful without opening the app:

Droppy is thirsty

+250 ml

Later

This is much better than requiring:

Notification → Open app → Find button → Record water.

## 19. Daily streak

Use a gentle streak, not a Duolingo-style punishment system.

Example:

6-day hydration streak

But if the user misses a day:

“That's okay. Let's start again today.”

Droppy shouldn't guilt the user.

That fits the non-irritating philosophy.

## 20. Privacy should be a selling point

Your Windows philosophy is already excellent:

Offline. Local. Private.

Keep that.

Android version:

No account required.

No cloud required.

No ads.

No water data uploaded.

Local database can store:

hydration

reminders

daily goals

schedules

character

preferences

This makes HydroPing feel like a genuine personal utility rather than a data-collection app.

## 21. Android architecture I'd recommend

For Android, I would not port the Python/PyQt architecture.

Build it natively:

Kotlin

■

■■■■ Jetpack Compose

■ ■■■ Main UI

■

■■■■ Jetpack Glance

■ ■■■ Home-screen widget

■

■■■■ Room

■ ■■■ Local SQLite database

■

■■■■ DataStore

■ ■■■ Settings

■

■■■■ WorkManager / appropriate scheduling

■ ■■■ Reminder scheduling

■

■■■■ NotificationManager

■ ■■■ Character notifications

■

■■■■ Character Engine

■■■■ Droppy

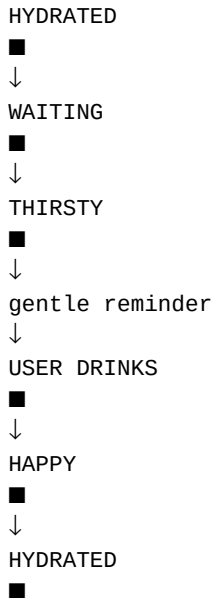
■■■■ Whiskers

■■■ custom characters

Glance widgets can react to user interactions and update from application state, although Android imposes

## The most important design decision

I would define HydroPing Android around this loop:



That is HydroPing.

The actual hydration calculation is almost secondary.

The product is really:

A tiny digital companion that notices you're neglecting water and gently gets your attention without beco

## My recommended Android MVP

If you're going to build this as a serious second version, I'd start with:

1. Droppy character engine
2. Onboarding
3. Daily water goal
4. Smart reminder scheduler
5. Character-based notifications
6. One-tap "I drank"
7. Home-screen Droppy widget
8. Daily hydration progress
9. Simple history
10. Character/personality selection
11. Sleep/quiet hours
12. Offline-first local database
13. Battery-efficient background scheduling
14. Optional persistent companion/bubble later

The widget + character notification + one-tap drinking interaction are the three features I would consider the heart of Android HydroPing.



And importantly, I would not try to force the Windows-style floating character onto Android as the primary mechanism. Android's notification/widget model is better suited to a companion that is present when useful rather than permanently sitting over other apps.